

**SANDEEP NAILWAL**

FOUNDER, POLYGON



On a blockchain, a fake certificate doesn't get created. And in case of discrepancies, police can access the real data directly

BHARAT ON A BLOCKCHAIN

As India has 17% of the world's Web3 developers, it becomes imperative to have a sovereign, secure, and open network of our own

▶ **INDIA HAS ALWAYS** had a way of doing the impossible.

We built UPI when most countries were still figuring out QR codes. We created Aadhaar when biometric IDs felt like sci-fi. Now, there's just one big piece of digital infrastructure we haven't built yet: our public blockchain network.

I come from a humble background, and I've seen what happens when systems don't work for you. A missing certificate, a land dispute, or a bureaucratic delay can derail lives and set families back by years. I've watched people lose their ancestral land, not because of a legal error, but because someone bribed the right official and walked away with a fake ownership certificate.

I was fortunate. Technology opened a door for me. But justice and opportunity should not depend on luck. We need to build systems that are fair, accessible, and built to protect those who need them the most.

Right now, a lot of Indian developers are building incredible things on global blockchain platforms, including Polygon. That's a testament to how far our ecosystem has come. But when it comes to national infra-

structure, control and sovereignty matter. Government pilots are often built on networks we don't fully govern. Our start-ups are still relying on external systems to build the future of Web3. It's like building your dream home on rented land. Shouldn't we also invest in something we fully own?

We have the talent, the experience, and the momentum to build our blockchain. A network that's owned by India, governed by India, but open to the world systems to interoperate with our systems, and built to service and improve the lives of our people.

Because let's face it—the value of blockchain has already been proven. The Maharashtra government used Polygon to issue tamper-proof caste certificates. Karnataka tracked Covid test results on-chain. Land records, supply chains, and education certificates are many use cases that already exist.

In the early days of blockchain, you couldn't have it both ways. If you wanted Web3 guarantees like trustless computation, self-custody, and censorship resistance, you had to give up control. You couldn't have one chain governed by a single entity like a company, a community, or a country. That just wasn't possible back then.